

Avitel Post Studioz

Behind the scenes at a major animation and post production house



NSD Powerball

The NSD Powerball is a toy and a machine that combines fun with a serious arm workout. It claims to be the most powerful gyroscope in the world, so we called in a couple of them for testing, and the team was absolutely addicted to them. What got us interested was that it was a good relief to those suffering from, or on the verge of carpal tunnel syndrome. The Powerball is a plastic sphere, with a rotor inside, that spins faster depending on how fast you can rotate it. When the forces build up, it becomes really hard to hold on to the powerball, and this gives the muscles in your arms a great workout.

We spent the first few hours getting the wrist movement right, which involved rotating the wrist in a circular motion over and over. Eventually, we ended up doing what the web site (www.powerballs.co.in) promised we would, and began competing for the high scores on the digital counter. High scores from around the world are recorded, the current ones being somewhere in the range of 16700 RPMs.

tech art: interactive art



Image Credit: www.nawlz.com

Online interactive comic books are not a new idea, and have been around for some time. However, no one has taken this concept as far as Stu Campbell and his collaborators. The comic is hosted at www.nawlz.com, and is regularly updated in an episodic format. Each episode has a mixture of visuals, animation, sound and some interactivity thrown in. The premise is a surreal cyberpunk adventure in a large, futuristic city, following a typical high-tech protagonist, Harley Chambers. There is some interactivity thrown in, about how the story is told, but it is essentially the same story no matter what you do. We suggest that you start soon, as there is a lot to catch up on. Also, follow the associated blog on <http://nawlz.com/blog>.

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